It is commonly said that terrorism is the weapon of the weak, and the weak in this context are the occupied, the poor, the hungry, the desperate, and the hopeless. This classic definition of terrorism does not apply to the al-Qaeda and ISIS schools of fundamentalist terrorism; these are very rich terrorist organizations that acquired permanent residency first in Sudan, a few years later in Afghanistan, and finally in Iraq and Syria. The leaders of these organizations are extremely wealthy, and their businesses finance the organizations' activities throughout the world. Many of these terrorist groups' members come from social classes that can be defined as middle class. These facts demonstrate that the root of the conflict is not socioeconomic but cultural.

The late 1970s were watershed years that saw the transition from the terrorism (for the sake of convenience we will refer to it as classical terrorism) of the first half of the twentieth century to the modern terrorism of the last quarter of the twentieth century and into the twenty-first century. Before we delve into the distinctions between these two types of terrorism, let us say a few words about the definition of the term *terrorism.*

First, there is no universal consensus on the definition of terrorism. The reasons for this lie in the political and international complexity of all the considerations and interests of states in their attempt to give the phenomenon a definition that would have universal legal validity. Because of this complexity, it is easier for the countries of the world to deal with the phenomenon of terrorism without defining it at all, or alternatively to define it "privately," in a way that can be reconciled with the laws of the state. For the purposes of this book, I will use the definition formulated by the International Institute for Counter-Terrorism (ICT) at the Interdisciplinary Center Herzliya (IDC), soon after it was established in 1996. Full disclosure: at the time of this writing, I serve as the chairman of ICT. This definition states that *terrorism is the use of violence against civilians to achieve political ends.*

ICT's definition was intended to be short and simple, in an effort to encourage broad international consensus—an attempt that has as yet been unsuccessful. It includes three necessary conditions for the definition of a phenomenon or behavior as terrorism: (1) violence as the means; (2) civilians as the target; and (3) political objectives.

The line between war and terrorism is crude. In order to refine it, we thought it appropriate to define another type of conflict—guerrilla warfare.